

This section provides a general overview of Module 3. It includes basic guidelines for preparing the assessment room and conducting the Module 3 administration. The general guidelines are followed by specific instructions for each activity in the module.

Module 3 of the ADOS-2 consists of 14 activities with 29 accompanying items. Activities are the tasks and interview questions administered by the examiner that allow for a standardized observation of the participant. In contrast, items are the targeted aspects of behavior that the examiner is focused on observing during the administration. Each item is rated by the examiner according to the general coding conventions and the specific coding criteria listed under each item in the Module 3 Protocol Booklet.

Before administering or coding Module 3, it is important to become familiar with all of the items and their accompanying codes. During or immediately following specific activities, the examiner should make written notes about behaviors (e.g., smiling and the voluntary offering of information) that influence coding. Coding should always be completed immediately following the session, based on the live administration. As specified in the instructions for each item, some ratings should be based on the participant's best performance, and others should be based on the consistency of the participant's responses or the examiner's need to repeat certain presses. Several of the codes refer to coordination of eye contact with vocal or gestural behaviors. This implies a linking or subtle meshing of appropriate eye contact with vocalizations or gestures used for communicative purposes, not just the simultaneous use of these different behaviors.

Module 3 is designed for use with children and adolescents who fall within the range of later preschool years up through 15 years of age and who have "fluent" language skills (estimated at a 4-year-old level in functional expressive language or higher). Some very verbal 3-year-olds may have sufficient language for a Module 3, though specific questions and tasks may need to be modified slightly to be age appropriate. Module 3 should not be given to 2-year-olds even if they have sufficient language (2-year-olds with fluent speech should be given Module 2).

With adolescents, examiners may choose between Modules 3 and 4, depending on the participant's interests and level of independence. Module 3 is generally appropriate for adolescents through 15 years of age, whereas Module 4 is generally appropriate for adolescents aged 16 years and older. Some clinicians and researchers may wish to err on the side of administering Module 3 to adolescents when deciding between Modules 3 and 4, because the Module 4 algorithms have not been revised as recently as those of Module 3 and because the Comparison Score is not yet available for the Module 4 algorithm. In addition, some older adolescents may be more comfortable with the structure and visual supports provided by the Module 3 materials. Although many younger adolescents no longer play with action figures (as in "Make-Believe Play"), most are comfortable showing the examiner how they would have played with similar materials when they were younger or in using such materials to create imaginative schemes (see later in this chapter). If an adolescent is clearly uncomfortable with the Module 3 materials after some encouragement, however, Module 4 can be administered.

Fluent Speech CHILD/ADOLESCENT

1. Construction Task
2. Make-Believe Play
3. Joint Interactive Play
4. Demonstration Task
5. Description of a Picture
6. Telling a Story From a Book
7. Cartoons
8. Conversation and Reporting
9. Emotions
10. Social Difficulties and Annoyance
11. Break
12. Friends, Relationships, and Marriage
13. Loneliness
14. Creating a Story

The activities in Module 3 focus on social, communicative, and language behaviors important in the diagnosis of autism spectrum disorders (ASD) in verbally fluent children and adolescents. These activities combine a series of unstructured and structured situations that offer a variety of presses for particular kinds of social and communicative behaviors. Some of the activities are designed to provide a relaxed, informal, and unstructured social setting in which the participant must take the initiative to make social overtures. The goal is to determine how well he or she is able to initiate and sustain a social interaction in situations with a minimal amount of structure or direction. Other activities in Module 3 are deliberately structured so that the examiner provides a standardized social-communicative task designed to determine how the participant responds to and builds on specific social stimuli and demands.

Module 3 as a whole has three specific goals: (a) to observe the participant's spontaneous social-communicative behavior, given a situation that provides a press to communicate or interact; (b) to assess the participant's ability to carry out particular tasks effectively and appropriately, given the demands of particular situations (e.g., telling a story, teaching a routine skill); and (c) to provide a standard context for the collection of a language sample. Module 3 also offers opportunities to observe the individual's sense of humor and creativity.

The general format of Module 3 creates interactions that seem natural, and during which planned occasions for certain behaviors arise. Specific social or communicative contexts are defined by variations in demands, in type of materials, and in the behavior of the examiner. The complexity of materials and demands will vary according to the age and developmental level of the participant. Specific events are staged by the examiner in a planned fashion. For example, some objects may be placed out of the examiner's reach at the end of a task in order to see if the participant spontaneously helps when the examiner is putting the materials away, or the examiner might offer a conversational opening that invites a response (e.g., "Oh, I remember where I've seen one of these before") in order to see whether the participant will follow this lead.

The heterogeneity within ASD requires that the examiner adapt the ADOS-2 tasks and materials to the level appropriate for each participant, while at the same time providing a social press in each task that is generally comparable across individuals. For example, before asking a very young child questions about marriage, the examiner might ask if the child knows anyone who is married. In general, the order of activities should be flexible and determined by the flow of the interaction. Some participants may prefer activities involving materials (e.g., "Description of a Picture"), while others prefer the more structured interview components (e.g., "Emotions"). It is advisable to shift between different types of tasks as necessary.

The ADOS-2 differs substantially from other types of assessments, such as cognitive testing or psychiatric interviews. The session as a whole is primarily designed to assess social and communication behaviors; therefore, it is crucial to prevent the session from resembling a clinical interview. It is essential from the outset to provide an interactive model, commenting on the participant's activities or statements and introducing brief observations about the examiner's own interests or activities. Many children and adolescents will expect a more directive question-and-answer approach from an adult authority figure, and the examiner must counteract this by adopting an informal, personal, interactive style that makes use of creativity, imagination, humor, and sometimes even gentle teasing. Generally, a psychotherapeutic style, in which the examiner interprets the participant's comments back to him or her, is not helpful in this context unless the participant is becoming distressed, in which case topics should be changed and the participant comforted. The examiner also should avoid a task-oriented style (as in a cognitive assessment).

Module 3 is typically administered without a parent/caregiver present in the room. If the participant insists on having a parent/caregiver present or if a parent/caregiver's presence is required because of some other unusual circumstance, it is important to avoid any involvement of the parent/caregiver in the activities. If a parent/caregiver is present during the administration, none of the behaviors directed to the parent/caregiver can be considered in assigning ratings.

Most of the items that are coded in Module 3 emphasize social skills already present in typical development by 2 or 3 years, or behaviors that are deviant at any age. However, some ratings assess skills that continue to change and develop (e.g., the ability to communicate different emotions). It is essential that, in all cases, observations be accompanied by a standardized assessment of the participant's language and nonverbal cognitive skills. In addition, as with all modules of the ADOS-2, this assessment must be combined with other information (e.g., developmental history) when used for diagnostic purposes.

For each activity, there is a specified focus of observation with respect to the participant's behavior in that task. Ratings are completed at the end of the assessment on the basis of the participant's behavior during the Module 3 administration. The examiner should be thoroughly familiar with these ratings so that they may be kept in mind throughout the session. It is not appropriate to read the ADOS-2 Manual during the administration of the assessment. If the examiner has not had sufficient practice to work from the Protocol Booklet and brief notes, the administration cannot be considered valid.

Figure 5 lists the standard set of materials used with the activities in Module 3. Note that there are no materials for any of the interview questions. The materials of the ADOS-2 have been selected specifically for individual tasks and presses. Examiners should avoid introducing additional materials that are not included as part of the standard administration. Additional materials may be used to motivate the participant if absolutely necessary, but they should never be used as alternative stimuli for standard tasks. Conducting the assessment in a person's home may make it more difficult to control the assessment environment or to prevent the introduction of extraneous materials. When it is necessary to complete the ADOS-2 administration in the home setting, care should be taken in figuring out where to work and how to lay out materials.

Preparing the Assessment Room for the Module 3 Administration

- Pay close attention to the physical structure of the setting, including the available furniture and space, to select an arrangement that is most suitable. In order to provide encouragement for informal back-and-forth interactions and communication, it is generally most appropriate to have an arrangement in which you and the participant are facing each other diagonally at the corner of the table or at a round table. It is preferable to avoid an arrangement in which you and the participant are seated opposite one another across a table, as this arrangement may feel confrontational to the participant.

Beginning the Module 3 Administration

- Begin the assessment with an attempt to put the participant at ease. This should involve comments of greeting and some indication that the session will involve a variety of activities and conversations.

Activities	Materials needed
1. Construction Task	puzzle pieces and printed design to be duplicated
2. Make-Believe Play	Bag 3: 2 male action figures, 1 female action figure, 3 "props" (one for each action figure), miniature hairbrush, 2 small tools, toy dinosaur Bag 2: small spoons and plates, several pieces of miniature food, small teapot/pitcher/measuring cup, miniature book, toy car, toy rocket, small ball, hologram disk, and two pieces of "junk" (small piece of cloth and small "jewelry" box)
3. Joint Interactive Play	materials from "Make-Believe Play" (Bags 2 and 3)
4. Demonstration Task	hand towel and soap (if necessary)
5. Description of a Picture	U.S. map scene and resort scene
6. Telling a Story From a Book	2 picture storybooks for Modules 3 and 4
7. Cartoons	Series A: fisherman/pelican series Series B: monkey/coconut series
8. Conversation and Reporting	—
9. Emotions	—
10. Social Difficulties and Annoyance	—
11. Break	mini game (e.g., shape puzzle), drawing paper, set of 8 markers, pin art, spin pen (spin top with pen base), small radio, current newspaper and magazine
12. Friends, Relationships, and Marriage	—
13. Loneliness	—
14. Creating a Story	6 small objects with a definite purpose (e.g., umbrella, car), 6 small objects with no clear purpose (e.g., piece of string, wooden block)

Note. Some of the materials listed in this figure are also used in other ADOS-2 modules.

Figure 5
Materials Used With Module 3

- Keep the introductory period short in order to move on to the “Construction Task.” The provision of some structure and focus in this task serves to put most individuals with ASD or other developmental disabilities at greater ease than they might feel if expected to participate in unstructured conversation.

During the Module 3 Administration

During the Module 3 administration, you must structure the interaction. The following guidelines are helpful:

- Aim for a standardized administration of 40 to 60 minutes. If the participant provides leads that may be important clinically (e.g., seems distressed while reporting bullying, or describes depressive symptoms), respond with a genuine but brief show of empathy and support, assuring the participant that those leads will be followed up as soon as the activities are completed. Remember to return to those topics as soon as you have finished the ADOS-2 administration, but do not include any of this follow-up information in your coding considerations.
- Take care to encourage and, to some extent, structure the task-oriented aspects of the assessment, without directly prompting specific behaviors. Your ability to carry out the administration in this style is critical in allowing the participant to exhibit his or her own level of social behavior.
- Refrain from providing so much help that there is no opportunity to observe the participant’s spontaneous behavior. In contrast, avoid providing so little structure that the participant is uncomfortable.
- Be both active and interactive in order to produce the appropriate presses for social-communicative interchanges. Nevertheless, except when specified otherwise, codes are primarily based on the participant’s initiatives in making, using, and developing these opportunities, rather than on his or her reactions to your behavior, creativity, or use of materials.
- Do not constantly strive to sustain the interaction. The participant must be provided with some clear opportunities to initiate and maintain interaction. For example, you may sometimes need to be quiet, or allow an “awkward silence” to persist for a moment or two.
- Take care to avoid coding stereotyped or imitative responses as showing creativity. The ADOS-2 consists of relatively brief observations, however, so expectations for extraordinary originality should not be high.
- Use opportunities throughout the session to assess the participant’s language skills and style of communication. Follow the participant’s lead whenever appropriate. The participant’s communication style is much better evaluated on the basis of language production during a back-and-forth conversational interchange than through question-and-answer cross-examination. This means that the conversation phase of the Module 3 assessment can be introduced earlier or later than indicated in the standard sequence of activities. Conversational interchanges can (and should) also occur throughout the other activities, not only during the specified “Conversation and Reporting” task.
- Give appropriate encouragement and praise throughout the session, and clearly share enjoyment in the participant’s activities.
- Observe whether the participant shows any repeated unusual or inappropriate behaviors or social disinhibition (e.g., touching your hand, picking his or her nose). If so, make an overt attempt at some point to ask the participant to stop, or you should try to prevent these behaviors. For example, interrupt the participant while he or she is providing a long list of dates. This attempt will enable you to determine how much the participant’s behaviors interfere with the interaction, as well as how the participant responds when he or she is interrupted.
- Note that some of the tasks are arranged so that there are two or more opportunities for the participant to show the behavior to be coded. For example, the “Description of a Picture” activity includes two potential pictures. In general, it is not necessary to provide the additional opportunities if the participant has produced the behaviors that are the focus of observation during the first opportunity.

Instructions for Activities in Module 3

This section includes specific instructions for each activity in Module 3. The specific activity instructions include the purpose of the activity, the materials needed, administration instructions, and the focus of the observation. Within each set of activity instructions, verbal directions to the participant are written in **bold**.

1. Construction Task

Purpose: This task serves as a warm-up activity and an opportunity to observe the participant's interactive behavior during a structured activity. For this reason, the task should be easy for the participant to complete and should result in a clear product (so that he or she can see that materials are missing). In addition, the task allows for observation of whether and how the participant asks for help within the context of a structured task.

In this task, the participant is asked to assemble blocks to construct a design shown on a printed form. The sole purpose of the task is to create an opportunity for the participant to ask for help; it is not to measure his or her motor or visual-spatial skills.

Materials: Puzzle pieces and printed design to be duplicated.

Instructions:

- Remove all of the puzzle pieces from their container, and place them on the table so that the participant can see them but cannot reach them. It is essential that you sit sufficiently far apart from the participant so that some of the blocks can be placed outside of the participant's reach.
- Place the printed design in front of the participant, point to the puzzle pieces and the design, and say, "I want you to put these pieces together to fill in this picture. You are supposed to use all the pieces. You can start with these [hand a few pieces to the participant]. Let me know when you need more pieces."
- Keep the remaining pieces on the table within sight but outside of the participant's reach and on the other side of your arm. Gesture to indicate the pieces you have kept and ensure that the participant can see these additional pieces. When the participant has assembled the few pieces he or she was given, wait to see whether the participant will ask for access to the remaining pieces. If so, provide the participant with a few additional pieces at a time. If the participant does nothing, deliberately look at him or her.
- Observe the participant's response to your direct gaze. If the participant makes no response to your direct gaze in 3 to 5 seconds, gesture toward the participant's design and say, "Are you doing alright?" or "How are you doing?" If the participant makes no response to your general prompt, then you can use a more specific prompt by asking, "Do you need more pieces?"
- Continue the task until all the puzzle pieces are in place. When the task is finished, place the container for the puzzle pieces in front of the participant, and open it. Then, put some of the pieces in the container while saying, "Let's move on to something else." Watch to see whether the participant helps to put away the remaining pieces.

Special administration notes: You should ensure that the task does not take more than a few minutes and is not frustrating for the participant because of visual-spatial or motor demands. For this reason, two versions of the design, one with and one without lines demarking each piece, are provided on alternate sides of the printed design form. In addition, if the participant seems unable to complete the design, you may complete most of the "puzzle" for him or her and ask him or her to finish it.

Focus of observation: Observe and evaluate whether the participant indicates the need for more pieces and how he or she attempts to do so. (For example, does he or she reach over your arm? Does he or she vocalize, gesture, or make eye contact?)

2. Make-Believe Play

Purpose: This activity provides the opportunity to observe the participant's creative or imaginative use of miniature play objects in an unstructured task.

Materials: Contents of Bag 3—two male action figures and a female action figure, with one "prop" for each; miniature hairbrush; two small tools; toy dinosaur. Contents of Bag 2—small spoons and plates, several pieces of miniature food, small teapot/pitcher/measuring cup, miniature book, toy car, toy rocket, small ball, hologram disk, and two pieces of "junk" (a small piece of cloth and a small "jewelry" box). If necessary, other materials from Module 2 may be added (i.e., from Bag 1), but because they require somewhat less creativity, the difference in contexts from the standard presentation should be taken into account when coding.

Instructions:

- Lay out the materials from Bag 3. Introduce the action figures with descriptions appropriate to their appearance (e.g., "Here are a princess, a wrestler, and a soldier, and their pet dinosaur").
- Lay out the materials from Bag 2, saying, "Here are some of their things. Can you play with these for a while?"

- Observe the participant's behavior. If the participant does nothing or seems uncomfortable, then after a few moments, say, "I'll play with these."
- Pick up some of the objects for yourself and make some limited but creative use of the objects without including the participant. Your aim in doing so is to demonstrate some make-believe usage of the objects that is sufficiently limited in scope to allow the participant ample freedom to demonstrate his or her own creativity. Describe the events as you carry them out. Then, ask the participant, "What are you going to do with yours?" while gesturing toward the remaining toys.
- Comment, show interest, and encourage the participant throughout the task. However, be careful to not actually tell the participant what to do. It is often helpful to ask the participant to talk about what he or she is doing (e.g., "That looks interesting—what are you doing there?"). Prompting "backward" can also be encouraging without being directive (e.g., "How did this happen?" "Who is this?" or "Where did he come from?"). It is crucial to distinguish the participant's own creative use of the materials from merely copying your actions or responding to your specific prompts.

Special administration notes: If the requirement to "play" in front of you seems inappropriate for the participant, you may frame the task as the creation of a video game, music video, commercial, or television show. However, the goal here is to observe non-goal-directed play that is interactive and, thus, different from the "Creating a Story" activity later in the Module 3 assessment.

Focus of observation: Evaluate the extent to which the participant produces imaginative sequences of actions that involve using materials beyond their most obvious intention. Pay particular attention to whether and how the participant casts the dolls and action figures as animate beings and pretends that they are interacting with each other. In addition, note any repetitive or sensory interests in the materials. Also, observe social overtures, spontaneous language, facial expressions, gestures, and how the participant responds to you.

3. Joint Interactive Play

Purpose: This activity assesses the degree and quality of the participant's coordination of behavior and affect with you in joint interactive play. In order to meet this objective, it is crucial for you to set the scene by making it clear that the play is meant to be collaborative. After you have played together, there is an opportunity to assess whether the participant helps you to clean up.

Materials: Materials from "Make-Believe Play" (Bags 2 and 3).

Instructions:

- Begin this activity after the participant has had sufficient opportunity to initiate make-believe play on his or her own (as described in the instructions for "Make-Believe Play").
- Redefine the activity by saying, "Can I play, too? Who should I be?" or "Now I'd like to join you." Immediately proceed to manipulate the objects to produce a press for joint interactive play. For example, you might pick up an action figure and have it give something to the participant's figure.
- Observe the participant's response. If the participant responds, respond in turn, and then pause, giving the participant an opportunity to initiate play. If the participant does not respond, try some other interactive play.
- Make up to four attempts to elicit interactive play if the participant does not respond, using your imagination to think of appropriate ways of producing interactive play. Add complexities as appropriate (e.g., by getting a third figure to approach or intervene or by making comments about what is happening).
- Avoid directing the play too much. However, sometimes it can be helpful to say something such as "What do you want to be? I'll be the wrestler," and if necessary, hand the participant one of the action figures, saying, "Can you be the army guy?" It can also be useful to imitate in a positive way what the participant does. For example, say, "Oh, can I do that too?" and imitate the participant's actions. Watch the participant's reaction, and then modify your action to see whether the participant will change in the same way.
- Be sure to enter into the spirit of the play, and show pleasure or worry (or whatever emotion is appropriate) in relation to the play produced.
- Allow the joint play to continue for a few minutes. Then, tell the participant that it is time to move on to the next activity, and allow him or her the chance to help clean up the materials.

Focus of observation: Observe the *reciprocity* and *shared enjoyment* shown by the participant in interactive play. The goal is for the participant (not you) to develop the interaction and to provide a novel initiative that goes beyond

a direct response to your overtures. Note both whether the participant is able to suggest ideas for the play and whether the participant is able to follow or join in with your ideas about what could happen in the play sequence.

4. Demonstration Task

Purpose: This activity assesses the participant's ability to communicate about a familiar series of actions using gesture or mime with accompanying language, and to report on a routine event. In this task, the participant is asked to demonstrate toothbrushing and then to demonstrate handwashing (if necessary).

Materials: Hand towel and soap (if necessary).

Instructions:

- Begin the task by saying, **"Now we're going to play a different kind of pretend game. Let's pretend that I don't know how to brush my teeth, and I need you to teach me!"**
- Set the imaginary scene with appropriate gestures (if necessary, prompt the participant to wait and attend during this process). Say, **"Let's pretend that this is the sink, this is the hot water, and this is the cold water."** Pretend to draw a sink and faucet handles around the area of the table in front of the participant. Say, **"This is the toothbrush."** Then, pretend to draw the toothbrush. Say, **"This is the toothpaste."** Then, say, **"And this is a cup."** Again, indicate the pretend objects. These gestures should be slow and without extraneous movements.
- Avoid acting out any aspects of the task (e.g., turning a faucet on) unless necessary to get the participant started; this is important because the participant cannot receive credit for using a gesture that you already demonstrated.
- Reiterate, **"Now I want you to show me and tell me how to brush my teeth. Start right at the beginning. You've just come into the bathroom to brush your teeth. What do you do now?"**
- Observe the participant's demonstration. If the participant demonstrates an isolated action very rapidly and conventionally, or pantomimes without speaking, say, **"That's great. Now, tell me and show me again right from the beginning—from when you first came into the bathroom."** Similarly, if the participant talks without producing any gestures, say, **"That's great. Now can you try it again, but this time show me and tell me at the same time."**
- Determine whether the participant has understood the task. If the participant does not understand the idea of the task, describe the scene again in the same manner. If the participant continues to demonstrate a clear lack of understanding of the task (i.e., if the participant stares blankly and does not attempt the task), you may demonstrate (in very simple terms) a different event (e.g., using words and gestures to demonstrate driving a car by first putting the key in, turning on the engine, and holding the steering wheel) before proceeding to the alternative task of handwashing. *Note that the demonstration of a different event should occur only if the participant does not understand the task; you should not demonstrate just because the participant fails to adequately integrate gesture and language.*
- Proceed to handwashing. Conduct this trial in a fashion similar to the toothbrushing event; this time setting the scene explicitly by pointing out the following *pretend* objects: soap, a hand towel, and a sink with faucet handles.
- Say, **"Now I want you to teach me how you wash your hands using soap."** If the participant still does not seem to understand the task, reset the scene once more, using the real soap and towel with the pretend sink. These real materials are included primarily to end the activity on a successful note for those participants who are unable to act out or explain a routine event.

Focus of observation: Determine whether and how the participant represents familiar actions in gesture, particularly through the use of his or her body to represent an object (e.g., a finger for a toothbrush) or in miming the use of a pretend object. In addition, use this activity as an opportunity to evaluate the participant's report of a routine event and the pragmatics of teaching a sequence of actions.

5. Description of a Picture

Purpose: This activity provides an opportunity to generate a sample of language and/or other communicative behaviors.

Materials: U.S. map scene and resort scene. Both pictures should be available, but generally only one is used for each participant. The simpler feast scene from Module 2 may be used as an alternative, if it is more appropriate to the participant's developmental level or interests.

Instructions:

- Tell the participant, **"Let's look at this picture now. Can you tell me about it? What is happening here?"** The aim is to generate language, so encourage the participant to comment about the picture, and respond positively to what the participant says.
- Be enthusiastic and interested in what the participant says, but do not provide further substantive information about the picture that is being described. For example, if the participant points to the sailboat and says, "That looks like a sailboat," you might say, **"I've never been on one. Have you?"** If the participant indicates the man on the surfboard and says, "Look, he's near the Hollywood sign," you might say, **"You're right"** or **"Yes, he is. Have you ever been to California?"**
- Note whether the participant relates the picture to his or her own experiences (family, friends, activities, and so on). If so, encourage this opportunity to generate conversation. The conversation can be evaluated when codes are assigned at the end of the assessment.
- Comment and use a variety of general questions and responses throughout the activity. Refrain from modeling or asking specific questions about particular parts of the picture.
- Allow the participant time to comment on the picture spontaneously and to respond to general prompts and questions as just described. If the participant does not respond to general prompts and questions, provides only isolated specific labels of objects or people, or mentions only one statement containing an agent, object, or action, then you should model the use of more complex language. For example, you might say, **"Look over here. That man on the tractor must be a farmer. He's next to a big ear of corn."** If the participant has not made any such statements or identified any objects in the picture, then you should ask specific questions: **"What's this?" "Who is this?" "What is he doing?"** or **"What is happening over here?"** Continue to provide encouragement and amplification of the participant's answers.
- Present the second picture only if a sufficient language sample is not obtained with the first picture or if the participant shows no interest in the first picture.

Focus of observation: Obtain a sample of the participant's spontaneous language and communication, as well as a sense of what captures his or her interest.

6. Telling a Story From a Book

Purpose: This activity assesses the participant's ability to recount a sequential story from a book of pictures and to provide a context for comments about social relationships and affect.

Materials: Either of the two picture storybooks from the materials for Modules 3 and 4 may be used. Two books are provided in case one is not appropriate for the participant (e.g., the participant has recently seen one of the books).

Instructions:

- Present one of the books to the participant and say, **"Let's look at this book. It tells a story in pictures. See, it starts out with..."** [describe the first picture in the book]. **"Can you tell me the story as we go along? You go first. Then, I'll take a turn."** This instruction is provided to help the participant orient to the book's story and to warn the participant that you may interrupt him or her.
- Hand the book to the participant, giving whatever prompts may be necessary to encourage him or her to start describing the story and then to turn the page. If the participant seems hesitant or reluctant, you should give *no more than two* specific prompts to get him or her started. For example, you might describe the action in one picture and say, **"I wonder what happens next,"** and then give the participant a chance to comment. If the participant focuses on specific details of individual pictures, you should say, **"You're right. Can you tell the story?"** or **"What are the pictures all about?"** (Make *no more than two* such prompts.)
- *Do not model labeling emotions.* For example, do not make comments such as "Oh look, this frog is really surprised." One of the focuses of this task is to observe whether the participant labels or comments on the emotions of the characters in the book. Therefore, the participant must have the opportunity to do so spontaneously.
- Allow the participant a few minutes to describe the book. Then say, **"That was great. Now I'll take a turn,"** and quickly complete the story for or with the participant. More back-and-forth turns can occur if you need to speed or slow the participant's pace through the story to prevent either the task taking too long or the participant rushing through the task without sufficient opportunities to observe behaviors. This also allows you to observe

whether the participant will allow someone else to take a turn telling the story. If the participant is determined to complete the story, note this, and let him or her do so.

Special administration notes: If the participant comments that the book seems "childish," you can call attention to some of the more creative aspects of the story (e.g., figures of speech) and eventually initiate a conversation around books the participant likes to read.

Focus of observation: Obtain a sample of the participant's spontaneous language and communication, as well as a sense of what captures his or her interest. In addition, evaluate the participant's response to conventional humor, his or her spontaneous comments about how the characters in the story are feeling, and the degree to which he or she can convey continuity in a story.

7. Cartoons

Purpose: This task provides an opportunity to observe the way in which the participant narrates a story, uses gesture to enact events, and integrates gesture with gaze and language. It also provides an opportunity for commenting on the emotions of the characters in the stories.

Materials: The *Series A* cartoons (a story involving a fisherman, a cat, and a pelican) and the *Series B* cartoons (a story about two monkeys and some coconuts). Each set of cards presents a brief story in cartoon form, one frame per card, without any dialogue or narrative text.

Instructions:

- Tell the participant that he or she will now be shown some cartoons and then will be asked to retell the story depicted in the cartoons without looking at the pictures.
- Choose either Series A or Series B, and offer a brief statement describing the setting of the cartoons in very general terms (e.g., "**This is a story about a fisherman and a cat**" or "**This is a story about two monkeys**").
- Look through the cards one by one with the participant, encouraging him or her to comment on what is happening in each card. Try not to give much information about the cards. If the participant is confused about what is happening in the story, however, you may help clarify the events depicted.
- *Do not model labeling emotions.* As with "Telling a Story From a Book," the participant must have the opportunity to do so spontaneously.
- Ask the participant to push his or her chair back from the table (so that the table is not within reach) and then to stand up and tell the story. It is often helpful if you stand up, too. It is important that the participant is not holding anything in his or her hands or touching the table, chair, or wall, and that his or her chair is pushed back from the table so that he or she will be able to gesture freely. If an observer is in the room, it may be helpful to ask the participant to tell the observer the story.
- Note whether the participant seems hesitant or uncomfortable.
 - If the participant seems hesitant to stand and retell the story, it can be helpful to place two pieces of paper on the floor in appropriate places, telling the participant to stand on one piece of paper as "the stage" while you stand on the other piece, signifying "the audience."
 - If the participant is markedly uncomfortable standing to retell the story, he or she may be permitted to remain seated; however, you should make a concerted effort to get the participant to stand. In the event that he or she insists on staying seated, attempt to get the participant to pull his or her chair away from the table, as most people are much more animated telling stories if they cannot prop their arms and hands on a table.
- Try to prevent the participant from looking at the story cards while retelling the story. Although participants will often ask to do so, it is important to prevent them from doing so whenever possible because individuals are much less likely to gesture when looking at the story cards. If the participant appears to be particularly distressed about it, however, you can say, "**Give it a try first, and I'll hold up a card to help you remember if you really need it.**" Remember that the "Cartoons" activity is *not* a test of the participant's memory of the story but rather is intended to provide information about how the participant uses various modes of communication to retell a story.
- Proceed to the second series of cartoons only if the first series is "spoiled" in some way (e.g., the participant puts his or her hands in his or her pockets during the retelling but seems too anxious to be interrupted, or he or she insists on looking at the cards). In this event, ask the participant to retell the second series of cartoons using the procedures just described for the first series.

Focus of observation: Observe the participant's use of gesture and its coordination with speech, as well as his or her response to humor. Also, use this task to obtain an additional language sample from the participant and a sense of his or her degree of flexibility in adapting a narrative to the audience of the listener. In addition, note any comments the participant makes about emotions and relationships.

8. Conversation and Reporting

Purpose: This activity assesses the participant's ability to engage in a conversation with back-and-forth interchanges and to describe an event or situation that occurred outside of the immediate context. In addition, this activity evaluates the participant's ability to recount a nonroutine event (e.g., a birthday party, a vacation, a particular interaction with a person at school). This task also provides an opportunity to generate a language sample in less structured circumstances than are provided by the picture tasks.

Materials: None.

Instructions:

- Use necessary judgment throughout the evaluation to determine what is most likely to set the participant at ease and to invite conversational interchange. Ordinarily, the conversational phase works best if you start with talk about what has happened during the session or about what the participant has said. At an appropriate time, develop the conversation to discuss topics outside the immediate situation (e.g., school or work, siblings, leisure activities) in order to assess the participant's ability to report on situations or events that have happened in the past.
- Use earlier opportunities for conversation during the session if this seems appropriate. For example, conversation about the participant's interests in reading novels or watching movies could be a topic that follows the activity "Telling a Story From a Book."
- Avoid a question-and-answer-style interaction, instead making a deliberate effort to use a conversational approach in responding to the participant, commenting on what he or she says and developing the discussion further.
- Show interest and involvement in the conversation and respond to the participant's talk with appropriate "hand-over" prompts in order to provide a press for a back-and-forth interchange. To emphasize the reciprocal nature of the task, you should provide conversational leads—for instance, by making brief statements about your own interests, activities, or feelings—and then wait to see whether the participant can build upon or follow up on such comments.
- Provide an opportunity for the participant to describe a nonroutine event (e.g., a vacation or family celebration). This event should be something that actually occurred, as opposed to an account of a film or story. For example, a report about a vacation or family celebration may follow from "Description of a Picture." Specific questions may be needed to introduce a topic. At some point, however, you should stop maintaining the conversation and remain silent for a few seconds while looking interested, to see whether the participant can take the initiative to recount an event without a specific prompt.

Special administration notes: In order to observe whether the participant can carry on a conversational interchange, you must provide sufficient leads, guides, and prompts on topics. Many individuals with ASD become very inhibited if presented with an unstructured situation that is too open, and in which they have to take the lead with an unfamiliar authority figure. It is, therefore, important for you to make appropriate use of the participant's own interests in such an interchange, by incorporating the participant's earlier statements, comments, or questions whenever possible. Conversations can begin about a participant's strongest interests but should not be centered exclusively on preoccupations or specific favorite topics (e.g., power tools). The conversation should include some discussion of age-appropriate topics of interest (e.g., music, pets, outings, sports) that are not stereotyped or circumscribed.

Focus of observation: Evaluate the extent to which the participant builds on your statements, elaborates on his or her own statements to provide leads for you, and takes a full role in back-and-forth conversation, particularly about a topic outside of the immediate context. Pay particular attention to how the participant reports *routine* and *nonroutine events* and how he or she describes *relationships* and *emotions*. Also, observe features of the participant's communication, including his or her use of gaze, facial expression, intonation, and gesture.

9. Emotions

Purpose: This task provides a context in which the participant talks about emotions and personal experiences. The goal is to observe both the content of what the participant says and also the degree to which the child or adolescent

who is verbally fluent can use language to talk about more abstract topics, particularly those associated with emotions. The requirement to talk about how one feels during different emotions is intended as a press to talk about a topic that is a challenge for many people. It is not intended as a test of cognitive function, so if it is very difficult for the participant, you should note this and continue to the next probe.

Materials: None.

Instructions:

- Introduce the task by saying, "Now I'd like to ask you a few questions." *Do not introduce the task as an "emotions" task.*
- Ask the "Emotions" interview questions in any order you choose. It is often appropriate to begin or end with "happy" or other positive emotions.
- Continue to ask the "Emotions" interview questions until the participant has given detailed descriptions of at least *two* emotions, including the contexts in which they arise and the nature of the participant's individual experience of these emotions. You need not ask about all emotions if the participant offers vivid and clear descriptions of emotions.
- Do not remain on one emotion probe for too long. Do not "insist" on a good response before moving on; many participants may not be able to provide detailed descriptions of emotions.
- End the task after the participant has provided enough detail (as just described) or after all of the "Emotions" interview questions have been asked. If you are uncomfortable ending this segment with questions about negative emotions, you may want to follow up with questions about anticipating something pleasant or about feeling relaxed and peaceful.

Interview questions:

- "What do you like doing that makes you feel happy and cheerful?"
- "What kinds of things make you feel this way? How do you feel when you're happy? Can you describe it?"
- "What about things that you're afraid of?"
- "What makes you feel frightened or anxious? How does it feel? What do you do?"
- "What about feeling angry?"
- "What kinds of things make you feel that way? How do you feel 'inside' when you're angry?"
- "Most people have times when they feel sad. What kinds of things make you feel that way?"
- "How do you feel when you're sad? What is it like when you're sad? Can you describe that?"
- "How about feeling relaxed or content? What kinds of things make you feel that way?"

Focus of observation: Identify the events or objects that elicit different emotions in the participant, particularly whether they are social in nature or not. In addition, observe how the participant describes his or her emotions. Also, observe whether the participant exhibits facial expressions or creative uses of language in the context of describing his or her emotions and others' emotions, and whether he or she displays insight into typical social relationships that may cause some of these emotions.

10. Social Difficulties and Annoyance

Purpose: These interview questions assess the participant's insight into personal social difficulties and sense of responsibility for his or her own actions.

Materials: None.

Instructions:

- Ask all of the "Social Difficulties and Annoyance" interview questions in the order listed here.
- Note that for older adolescents who may work as well as attend school (or who only work and do not attend school), it is acceptable to ask about work in addition to or instead of school.

Interview questions:

- "Have you ever had problems getting along with people at school? How about at home with your family? Do you ever get in trouble? Why? What for?"
- "Are there things that other people do that irritate or annoy you? What are they?"

- “What about things you do that annoy others?” (If no response, ask: “What about your brother(s) or sister(s) or parents?”)
- “Have you ever been teased or bullied? Why, do you think?”
- “Have you ever tried to change these things? Have you ever done anything so that others wouldn’t tease you? How has it worked?”
- “Are there other kids/people you know who get teased or bullied?”

Focus of observation: Evaluate the participant’s perception of social difficulties, his or her insight into the nature of these problems, and whether he or she has made any attempt to change his or her own behavior in order to fit in with others more smoothly. Pay attention to the participant’s understanding of the appropriateness and implications of his or her feelings and behaviors.

11. Break

Purpose: The primary purpose of this activity is to observe the participant’s behavior in less structured circumstances. A secondary purpose is to give the participant a break from the social demands of the assessment.

Materials: Mini game (e.g., shape puzzle), drawing paper, set of eight markers, pin art, spin pen (spin top with a pen base), small radio, and current copies of a newspaper and a magazine. If the participant requests them, the materials from “Make-Believe Play” may also be put out during the “Break.” A snack may be provided, if necessary.

Instructions

- Determine an appropriate time for the “Break” activity to occur. The break may be given at any time during the assessment. Several breaks may be taken, if necessary. The materials for the break may be presented at the very end of the Module 3 assessment if it seems that the participant would be most comfortable completing the more structured activities first.
- Say, “**Let’s take a break,**” and indicate that you need some time to catch up on your notes.
- Point to the specified “Break” materials, and express the hope that the participant can find something of interest among them. If the participant is unfamiliar with any of the materials, you should demonstrate how they work (e.g., take the cap off the spin pen, put your hand in the pin art).
- Say, “**I need to make some notes for a few minutes,**” and move your chair back from the table so that you are sitting within view but away from the table where the participant is sitting.
- Note the participant’s interest in the “Break” materials. If none of the provided materials interests the participant, ask the participant if there is something else he or she would like to do, or offer a snack and/or something to drink. Once the participant is settled and you have made a reasonable attempt to interest him or her in the materials (even if nothing is of interest), you should work on your notes for at least 2 minutes (slightly longer is fine if helpful to you or the participant).
- Observe whether the participant initiates an interaction. If so, respond briefly and positively, but indicate that you have to finish more paperwork before you can talk. After a few seconds, look up, catch the participant’s eye, and smile briefly in encouragement. The goal is to create an occasion for the participant to initiate an interaction. If this does not occur, you can return to your notes or say, “**I’ll just be another minute.**”
- Return to the table after a few minutes total. Make it clear that you are finished taking notes (e.g., pull your chair back up to the table, put your pen and Protocol Booklet down). Wait to see whether the participant invites you back into the interaction by making a social overture. If necessary, you can look at one of the objects on the table, indicating interest in it or what the participant is doing with it, but continuing to allow the participant to take the lead.

Special administration notes: This task should be completed with the “Break” materials as outlined. If the participant mentions a preference to leave the room during the break, you should clarify that this will be a very short break within the room. You can offer that a longer break will be possible soon (if needed). If a true break outside of the room is necessary (e.g., to use the restroom or take medication), be sure to administer the “Break” task as outlined here when the participant returns.

Focus of observation: Observe how the participant occupies himself or herself during free time and how he or she responds to your withdrawal from and return to the interaction. Also, observe whether and how the participant initiates and participates in an unstructured conversation or interaction with you at the end of the break.

12. Friends, Relationships, and Marriage

Purpose: These interview questions provide an opportunity to obtain a detailed description of one or more relationships that the participant would consider to be friendships and also to obtain a general description of his or her understanding of the concept of friendship and the idea of getting married or building a long-term relationship. Note that the purpose of this activity is *not* to determine whether the participant has friends but rather to evaluate how he or she understands the concepts of friendship and marriage/long-term relationships.

Materials: None.

Instructions:

- Ask all of the "Friends, Relationships, and Marriage" interview questions regardless of a participant's chronological age. The questions do not necessarily need to be read verbatim.
- Make appropriate modifications to the language of the questions, depending on the developmental level of the participant. For example, for a 4-year-old child who is administered Module 3, you might use simpler phrasing and/or ease into questions, such as saying, "**Do you know anyone who is married?**" Similarly, if the participant does not have any experiences with or is reluctant to talk about a girlfriend/boyfriend, you could ask, "**Do you know of anyone who has a girlfriend or boyfriend?**" and ask "**How do you know she/he is his/her girlfriend/boyfriend?**" Note that adolescent participants of either sex should be asked the question as worded: "**Do you have a girlfriend or boyfriend?**"
- Be sure to maintain the "spirit" of the questions and proceed through all of the questions in order to ensure that the information necessary for coding is elicited.
- Note that for older adolescents who may work as well as attend school (or who only work and do not attend school), it is acceptable to ask about work in addition to or instead of school.

Interview questions:

- "**Do you have some friends? Can you tell me about them?**" (Note the ages of the friends. It can be helpful to ask for names if the participant is very general about who his or her friends are. Sometimes the names provided are family members or professionals or a list of an entire class, which is useful to know in terms of interpreting the answers to the questions about friendship.)
- "**What do you like doing together? How did you get to know them? How often do you get together?**"
- "**What does being a friend mean to you? How do you know someone is your friend?**"
- "**How is a friend different from someone whom you just go to school with?**"
- "**Do you have a girlfriend or boyfriend? What is her/his name? How old is she/he?**"
- "**When did you see her/him last?**"
- "**What is she/he like? What do you like to do together?**"
- "**How do you know she/he is your girlfriend/boyfriend?**"
- "**Where do you want to live when you get older? What kind of place (apartment, house, condo)?**"
- "**Whom do you think you would like to live with? Your family, a roommate(s), by yourself?**"
- "**Do you ever think about having a long-term relationship or getting married (when you are older)?**"
- "**Why do you think some people get married or live with a girlfriend or boyfriend when they grow up?**"
- "**What would be nice about it? What might be difficult about being married or living with a girlfriend or boyfriend? Or living with a roommate?**"

Focus of observation: Evaluate how the participant understands the concepts of friendship, marriage, and other social relationships, and the nature of these relationships. Also, evaluate the participant's understanding of why a person might want to be involved in a long-term relationship and of his or her own possible role in such a relationship.

13. Loneliness

Purpose: These interview questions provide another opportunity to assess the participant's insight into his or her social situation, as well as the participant's ability to describe his or her emotional reaction to it.

Materials: None.

Instructions:

- Ask all of the "Loneliness" interview questions in the order listed here.

Interview questions:

- "Do you ever feel lonely?"
- "Do you think other kids/people your age ever feel lonely?"
- "Are there things that you do to help yourself feel better? What about things other people do to help themselves feel better when they're lonely?"

Focus of observation: Evaluate whether the participant understands the concept of loneliness and how he or she feels it pertains to him or her or to other people.

14. Creating a Story

Purpose: This task provides an opportunity to observe creativity in a play-like situation that is appropriate for verbally fluent children, adolescents, and adults. The participant's task is to use five objects to make up a story, newscast, or commercial.

Materials: Six small objects with a definite purpose (e.g., umbrella, car) and six small objects with no clear purpose (e.g., piece of string, wooden block).

Instructions

- Tell the participant, **"Now you and I are going to make up stories using some of these objects. First I will pick five things and use them to make up a story, and then you will have a turn to make up a story using five different things."**
- Model choosing five objects and making up a simple story. Use three objects in a creative or novel way (e.g., using a piece of sponge as a bed, using an umbrella as a basket) and two objects in the way that they were intended to be used (e.g., using a paper clip as a paper clip). Use one object as the "actor" in the story (e.g., **"Mr. Flame woke up one morning,"** using a candlestick). After you have modeled the creation of a story, place your five objects off to the side.
- Gear your story to the developmental level of the participant. Make it simple enough so as not to make the participant feel intimidated or overwhelmed by the task.
- Encourage the participant to select five new objects from the bag to use in making up a story of his or her own. It is generally advisable to leave the car for the participant to use, since this is a relatively easy object to incorporate into a story. Make sure that the participant does not select only "real" objects, however, so that he or she is forced to use at least some of the more abstract objects (i.e., "junk" objects) in creating his or her story. An easy way to do this is to be familiar with the objects in the "Creating a Story" bag such that using two or three "real" objects in your own story will leave only two or three "real" objects for the participant to choose.

Focus of observation: Observe and evaluate the participant's creative use of objects in telling a novel story or creating a newscast or commercial.